

SMART GROWTH QUESTIONS

The following questions will assist the Department in determining the proposed projects' compliance with the State Smart Growth Public Infrastructure Policy Act. Projects must demonstrate consistency with the relevant criteria included in the Act to be considered for funding.

1. Is the applicant for this DEC grant a public entity?

(Examples include: other state agency; State or local public authority; Federal agency; local sewer, water, or waste management district; public school or school district; SUNY or CUNY; public commission; county; or other entity that can reasonably be described as public and eligible to apply under the grant opportunity.)

Yes/No If yes, provide a brief explanation in the space below

Yes. The applicant is the Village of Saranac Lake, a local municipal government in Franklin County, New York. As a public entity, the Village owns and manages Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park, and is eligible to apply for DEC grants to support improvements on publicly owned land.

2. Does the proposed project support the construction or reconstruction of infrastructure?

(Examples include: construction or reconstruction of physical and permanent structures such as roads; water and sewer systems; permanent waste transfer, treatment or disposal facilities; schools and other buildings; and pipelines, transmission lines and other utility infrastructure).

Yes/No;

Explain briefly:

Yes. The proposed project supports the construction of accessibility improvements at Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park. Specifically, the project funds contractual services for preparation of construction drawings and bid documents for ADA-compliant pathways, restrooms, and site circulation enhancements, which are permanent infrastructure improvements on publicly owned land.

IF THE ANSWER TO THE PREVIOUS TWO QUESTIONS IS NO, IT IS NOT NECESSARY TO COMPLETE THIS FORM.

3. Have any other State infrastructure agencies issued a Smart Growth Impact Statement with regard to the proposed project?

Yes/No No

If yes, please upload a copy in the appropriate section of SFS.

Smart Growth Criteria (ECL § 6-0107(2))

4. Does the proposed project advance or otherwise involve the use of, maintain, or improve existing infrastructure?

Yes/No/ N/A;

Explain:

Yes. The project advances and improves existing infrastructure at Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park, which includes a beach pavilion with restrooms, parking areas, and pedestrian pathways. Funding for contractual services for construction drawings and bid documents will support upgrades to the existing pavilion and restrooms, enhancements to accessible pathways, ramps, and site circulation, and overall improvements to the park space, creating a fully ADA-compliant, safe, and welcoming environment for all visitors.

5. Is the proposed project located in a municipal center, characterized by any of the following:

- *A city or a village*
- *Area of concentrated and mixed land use that serves as a center for various activities including, but not limited to:*
 - *Central business district*
 - *Main Street*
 - *Brownfield Opportunity Areas*
(<https://www.dos.ny.gov/opd/programs/brownFieldOpp/BOAdesignations.html>)
 - *Downtown areas of Local Waterfront Revitalization Plan areas*
 - *Locations of transit-oriented development (such as projects serving areas that have access to mass or public transit for residents)*
 - *Environmental Justice areas* (<http://www.dec.ny.gov/public/899.html>)
 - *Hardship areas*
 - *Area adjacent to municipal center in an area with clearly defined borders that is designated for concentrated future development in a municipal or regional comprehensive plan, and exhibits strong land use, transportation, infrastructure and economic connections to a municipal center; or*

o Area that is included in a municipal or comprehensive plan and appropriately zoned in a municipal zoning ordinance as a future municipal center.

Yes/No;

Explain:

Yes. The project is located within the Village of Saranac Lake, a designated municipal center in Franklin County, NY. Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park is adjacent to the village core and is part of the village's recreational and community infrastructure. The park supports a mix of public recreation, tourism, and community gatherings, connecting to nearby streets, parking, and pedestrian pathways. Its location aligns with the Village's comprehensive plan and local waterfront revitalization goals, supporting concentrated public use and strong land use, transportation, and economic connections to the municipal center.

6. Is the proposed project located in a developed area or an area designated for concentrated infill development in accordance with a municipally-approved comprehensive land use plan, a local waterfront revitalization plan, or a brownfield opportunity area plan?

Yes/No;

Explain:

Yes. The project is located within the Village of Saranac Lake, a developed area with established infrastructure and public amenities. Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park is part of the village's comprehensive land use plan and Local Waterfront Revitalization Plan (LWRP), supporting concentrated public use and recreational activities. The project aligns with these plans by enhancing accessibility, improving existing park infrastructure, and encouraging continued use of a developed, community-focused area.

7. Does the proposed project protect, preserve or enhance the State's resources, including agricultural land, forests, surface or groundwater, air quality, recreation and open space, scenic areas, and/or significant historic and archeological resources?

Yes/No;

Explain:

Yes. The project enhances public recreation and open space at Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park. By funding contractual services for construction drawings and bid documents for accessibility upgrades, the project will improve ADA-compliant access while minimizing environmental impacts, preserving natural features, and maintaining scenic and recreational values. These improvements will ensure people of all ages and abilities can fully enjoy swimming, picnicking, and other outdoor recreational activities, while preserving the park's natural features, maintaining scenic quality, and supporting continued safe and inclusive public enjoyment of this key recreational resource.

8. Does the proposed project foster mixed land uses and compact development; downtown revitalization; brownfield redevelopment; the enhancement of beauty in public spaces; the diversity and affordability of housing in proximity to places of employment, recreation and commercial development; and/or the integration of all income and age groups?

Yes/No;

Explain:

Yes. The project fosters the enhancement of public spaces and recreation at Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park, one of the most utilized parks in the Village of Saranac Lake. As a public open space, it promotes the integration of all income levels and age groups, encourages community gatherings, supports tourism, and provides safe, inclusive, year-round recreational opportunities for all residents and visitors.

9. Does the proposed project provide mobility through transportation choices, including improved public transportation and reduced automobile dependency?

Yes/No;

Explain:

No. While the project does not directly provide improved public transportation or reduce automobile dependency, it enhances mobility within the park by improving walkways, pathways, and circulation. These upgrades support safe and accessible pedestrian movement and encourage visitors to navigate the park independently, and at ease, promoting active transportation as part of the recreational experience.

10. Does the proposed project demonstrate or support coordination among state and local government, or inter-municipal planning, or regional planning?

Yes/No;

Explain:

Yes. The project demonstrates coordination with local and municipal planning as the Village of Saranac Lake, which owns Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park, is leading the planning and design of the accessibility upgrades. The project aligns with the Village's comprehensive plan and Local Waterfront Revitalization Plan, ensuring that improvements are integrated with broader community goals for recreation, open space, and public access.

11. Does the proposed project involve community-based planning and collaboration?

Yes/No;

Explain:

Yes. The Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Accessibility Upgrades – Construction Drawings & Bid Documents project involves community-based planning and collaboration. As part of the Village's Local Waterfront Revitalization Plan (LWRP), the project and related improvements were chosen, vetted, and reviewed by residents and park users, ensuring that the resulting construction documents reflect community priorities and support safe, inclusive, and widely used public spaces for all ages and abilities.

12. Does the proposed project support predictability in building and land use codes?

Yes/No;

Explain:

Yes. The Construction of Accessibility Improvements at Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park project supports predictability in building and land use codes by ensuring that all construction drawings and bid documents are developed in full compliance with ADA standards, ABA guidelines, and local building codes. This provides clear guidance for contractors and ensures construction and future maintenance align with established regulations and community planning requirements.

13. Does the proposed project promote sustainability, reduce greenhouse gas emissions, and not compromise the needs of future generations?

Yes/No;

Explain:

Yes. This phase of the Construction of Accessibility Improvements at Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park, focused on contractual services for construction drawings and bid documents, does not directly impact greenhouse gas emissions or sustainability. However, it lays the groundwork for durable, accessible, and environmentally responsible improvements, preserving the park's natural and recreational resources and ensuring continued public enjoyment for future generations.

14. Does the proposed project encourage broad based public involvement in developing and implementing a community plan or ensure that there is a governance structure that is adequate to sustain a project's implementation?

Yes/No;

Explain:

Yes. The Construction of Accessibility Improvements at Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park project encourages broad-based public involvement as part of the Village's Local Waterfront Revitalization Plan (LWRP) process, where improvements were reviewed and vetted by residents, park users, and stakeholders. The Village of Saranac Lake, as the property owner and local planning authority, provides an established governance structure to oversee implementation, ensuring that the project is managed effectively and maintained for long-term community benefit.

15. Does the proposed project mitigate future physical climate risk due to sea-level rise, and/or storm surges and/or flooding, based on available data predicting the likelihood of future extreme weather events, including hazard risk analysis data, if applicable?

Yes/No;

Explain:

No. This phase of the Contractual Services for Construction Drawings & Bid Documents for Accessibility Upgrades at Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park does not directly mitigate climate risks such as sea-level rise, storm surges, or flooding. However, this phase will incorporate site-specific considerations to support future construction that is resilient, safe, and able to maintain accessibility under extreme weather conditions.